Workout Planner: App Concept

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Overview

LoopLift (working title) is a simple mobile workout planner: you build workouts from your own exercises, then put them on a calendar either day by day or as a repeating loop like Push, Pull, Rest.

Problem. People who train on a fixed split (Push/Pull/Legs, Upper/Lower, Full Body) already know their routine, but most fitness apps either push pre-made programs or focus on logging sets. Answering "what am I doing tomorrow?" should take one glance, not a spreadsheet.

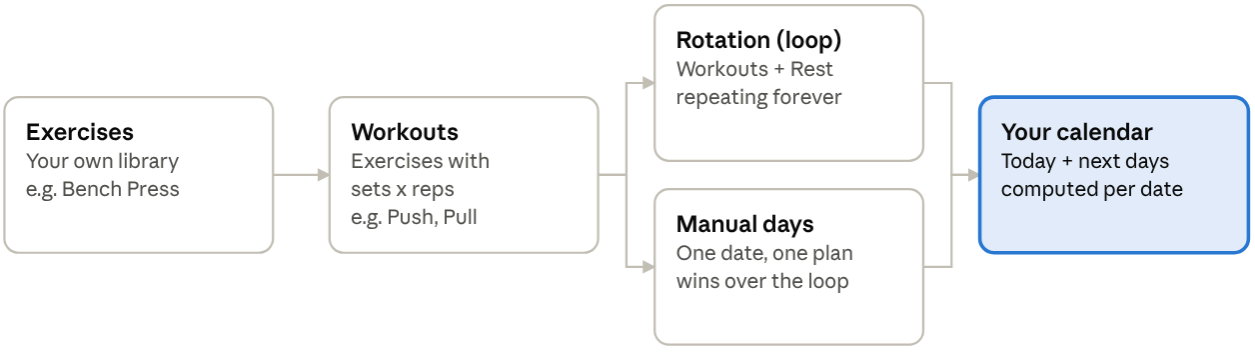
Target user. Someone who trains 3 to 6 times a week on a self-chosen split and wants to plan, not be coached.

Core promise. Set up your split once, press start, and the app always knows what today and the next days look like. Moving or swapping a single day never breaks the loop.

Core concepts

The app has four things you create and one thing it computes: exercises go into workouts, workouts go into a loop or onto single dates, and the calendar is derived from both.

Exercises build workouts; a loop or manual days put them on your calendar



how the parts fit together · 5 building blocks

- **Exercise:** a single movement, e.g. Bench Press. Lives in your library.
- **Workout:** a named, ordered set of exercises with target sets x reps, e.g. Push.
- **Rotation:** an ordered loop of workouts and rest days with a start date, e.g. Push, Pull, Rest.

- **Manual day:** one date set to one workout or Rest; it always beats the loop for that date.

Key flows and user stories

The whole app is three setup steps and one daily glance.

1. **Build your exercise list.** Pick from a small built-in list or add your own (e.g. "Incline DB Press").
2. **Create workouts.** Name a workout (Push), add exercises, set target sets and reps per exercise, reorder by drag.
3. **Plan your days.** Either assign workouts to specific dates, or create a rotation (Push, Pull, Rest) with a start date and let it repeat.
4. **Daily use.** Open the app, see today's workout and the next few days, tap to view the exercise list.

User stories (v1)

- As a lifter, I want to save the exercises I actually do, so I don't scroll through hundreds I never use.
- As a lifter, I want to group exercises into named workouts like Push and Pull, so I set them up once.
- As a lifter, I want to assign a workout or a rest day to a specific date, so I can plan the coming days.
- As a lifter on a fixed split, I want to define a loop (Push, Pull, Rest) that repeats automatically, so I never plan week by week.
- As a lifter, I want to swap or move one day (e.g. skip Push because of travel) without breaking the rest of the loop.
- As a lifter, I want to see today and the next 7 days at a glance, so I know what's coming.
- As a new user, I want sensible empty states ("No workouts yet, create your first"), so I know where to start.

Screens

Four tabs cover v1: Today, Calendar, Workouts, Exercises.

Tab	What it shows	Main actions
Today (home)	Today's workout or rest day as a big card, exercise list with sets x reps, a strip of the next 7 days	Open workout, mark as done, skip or swap today

Tab	What it shows	Main actions
Calendar	Month view, each day labelled with its workout (color per workout); rotation days and manual days visually distinguished	Tap a day to assign a workout or rest, clear an override, set up or edit the rotation
Workouts	List of workout templates (Push, Pull, Legs) with exercise count and color	Create, edit, duplicate, delete; inside a workout add, remove and reorder exercises, set target sets/reps
Exercises	Your exercise library, searchable, grouped by muscle group	Add custom exercise, edit name and muscle group, delete (warns if used in a workout)

Rotation editor (opened from Calendar): an ordered list of slots, each slot is a workout or Rest. Add slot, reorder by drag, pick a start date, see a 2-week preview before saving.

How the loop works

A day's plan is resolved in a fixed order: a manual entry for that date wins, otherwise the active rotation decides, otherwise the day is empty.

The rotation is computed, never stored day by day. That keeps it infinite, cheap, and easy to edit:

```
\text{slot}(d) = \big(\text{days}(start, d) - \text{shifts before } d\big) \bmod n
```

where n is the number of slots in the loop. Example: loop Push, Pull, Rest starting Monday 2 Nov 2026 gives Mon Push, Tue Pull, Wed Rest, Thu Push, Fri Pull, Sat Rest, Sun Push. A 3-day loop deliberately does not line up with weeks.

Changing a single day offers two options, because both are common in real life:

- **Replace this day only.** Saves a manual entry for that date (e.g. Rest instead of Pull). The loop continues as if nothing happened.
- **Push the loop back.** Adds a shift from that date on, so tomorrow becomes the workout you missed. Useful when you skip a session but don't want to lose it.

Edge cases to handle

- Editing the loop itself (e.g. adding Legs) applies from a chosen date forward; past days keep what they were.

- Deleting a workout that a rotation or manual day uses: block the delete or ask to replace it in those places.
- Only one active rotation at a time in v1; starting a new one ends the old one the day before.
- Days before the rotation start date show as empty, not as part of the loop.

Requirements

The P0 list is the smallest app that fully covers the idea; everything else waits.

Priority	Requirement	Done when
P0	Exercise library	User can add, rename and delete exercises; a starter list of about 20 common lifts is preloaded
P0	Workout templates	User can create a named workout, add exercises with target sets x reps, and reorder them
P0	Manual day planning	User can set any date to a workout or Rest, and clear it again
P0	Rotation (loop)	User can define an ordered loop of workouts and Rest with a start date; Calendar shows it repeating indefinitely
P0	Day overrides	"Replace this day" and "Push the loop back" both work and the rest of the loop stays correct
P0	Today screen	Shows today's plan plus the next 7 days; works on first launch with a helpful empty state
P0	Local persistence	All data survives an app restart; no account needed
P1	Mark as done	Tap "Done" on today's workout; Calendar shows completed days with a check
P1	Workout colors	Each workout has a color used in Calendar and the 7-day strip
P1	Daily reminder	Optional notification at a chosen time naming today's workout
P1	Rotation preview	Rotation editor shows the next 14 days before saving

Priority	Requirement	Done when
P2	Set logging	Log actual weight and reps per set, show last session's numbers
P2	Progress charts	Volume or top set per exercise over time
P2	Sync and backup	Account plus cloud sync across devices
P2	Multiple rotations	E.g. a deload week loop, or seasonal programs

Design the data model so P2 set logging attaches to a planned day without a migration.

Data model

Six small entities are enough; the calendar itself is derived, not stored.

Entity	Key fields	Notes
Exercise	id, name, muscleGroup, isCustom	Starter list ships with the app
Workout	id, name, color	A template, e.g. Push
WorkoutExercise	workoutId, exerciseId, order, targetSets, targetReps	Join table, keeps order and targets per workout
Rotation	id, startDate, endDate?, slots[]	Each slot = workoutId or "rest"; endDate set when replaced
RotationShift	rotationId, fromDate, days	Created by "Push the loop back"
DayEntry	date, workoutId or "rest", status	Manual override for one date; status = planned / done / skipped (done and skipped are P1)

Resolving a date: look up DayEntry for that date; if none, find the Rotation active on that date and apply the slot formula from the section above.

Non-goals for v1

v1 is a planner, not a tracker or a coach.

- **No set and weight logging.** It doubles the UI and is what every other app already does; planned for P2.
- **No pre-made programs or AI coaching.** The user brings their own split; that is the point of the app.

- **No accounts or cloud sync.** Local-only keeps the test project small and avoids a backend.
- **No social features or sharing.** Not needed to answer "what am I doing tomorrow?".
- **No wearable or Apple Health / Google Fit integration.** Adds permissions and platform work for little planning value.

Build plan and tech stack

Suggested stack: **Expo (React Native) with Expo Router and TypeScript**, data in **expo-sqlite** on the device. It runs on iOS, Android and web from one codebase, which makes it a good test of a project setup.

1. **Setup.** Create the Expo app, four tabs with Expo Router, empty screens, local database with the six tables.
2. **Library and workouts.** Exercises tab with starter list, Workouts tab with create/edit and reordering.
3. **Scheduling engine.** A pure function `resolveDay(date)` covering DayEntry, Rotation and RotationShift, with unit tests for the example loop and both override types. Build this before the Calendar UI.
4. **Calendar and rotation editor.** Month view, tap-to-assign, rotation editor with drag reorder and start date.
5. **Today screen and polish.** Today card, 7-day strip, empty states, workout colors.

Testing the scheduling logic in isolation (step 3) is the main risk reducer: if `resolveDay` is right, every screen is just a view on top of it.

Open questions

- [ ] When you skip a day, which should be the default: "Replace this day" or "Push the loop back"?
- [ ] Should a loop also support weekday-based plans (e.g. Mon Push, Wed Pull, every week), or is the N-day loop enough for v1?
- [ ] Is "Mark as done" needed in the first version, or is pure planning enough?
- [ ] Target platform for testing: iPhone, Android, web, or all three?
- [ ] Final app name (LoopLift is a placeholder).